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Welcome to Larkspur Analytics

Larkspur Analytics is a fictional data consultancy with offices in Bengaluru and Pune. This handbook explains the policies that apply to permanent employees. It is written for testing document question answering and does not describe any real organisation.

Each policy has an owner team. People Operations owns working time, leave and pay. The Finance team owns travel and expenses. The Security Office owns information security and remote work abroad. Facilities owns health and safety at our offices.

Most requests use a short form code, for example HR-12 or TRV-2. All forms are available on the intranet under Self Service. If a form is unavailable, email the owner team and describe your request in writing; a written request has the same effect as the form.

Policies are reviewed every January. When a policy changes, People Operations publishes a summary of the change on the intranet and the new version applies from the first day of the following month. If this handbook and a signed employment contract disagree, the contract takes precedence.

New employees complete an induction during their first week. Induction covers the tools we use, how projects are staffed, and who to contact in each owner team. Your manager will also assign a buddy from another team who can answer informal questions during your first three months.

Questions about a policy should go first to your manager. If your manager cannot answer, contact the owner team listed above. Decisions that make an exception to a policy must be recorded in writing so that the same request is treated consistently in future.

Working hours and attendance

Core hours are 10:00 AM to 4:00 PM, Monday to Friday. Outside core hours you may choose when to start and finish, provided you work 40 hours per week on average over a month.

Record your hours in a weekly timesheet. Timesheets are submitted with form HR-12 by 12:00 noon every Monday for the previous week. Client projects are billed from these timesheets, so late or missing timesheets delay invoices.

If you are running late or cannot attend, tell your manager before 10:00 AM by message or phone. Repeated unexplained absence is handled under the conduct policy.

Overtime must be agreed in advance by your manager. Approved overtime is compensated with time off in lieu at the same number of hours; it is not paid as additional salary. Time off in lieu must be used within three months of the overtime being worked.

Part-time employees agree their working pattern with their manager when they join. The same core hours apply on the days they work, and their leave allowance is calculated in proportion to their contracted hours.

Meetings should be scheduled within core hours wherever possible, so that colleagues using flexible start and finish times can attend. Recurring meetings outside core hours need the agreement of everyone invited.

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Annual leave and public holidays

Employees receive 24 days of paid annual leave in each leave year. The leave year runs from 1 January to 31 December. New joiners receive a pro-rated allowance for their first year.

Request annual leave with form HR-17. For absences longer than three days, submit form HR-17 at least 10 working days before the first day of leave. Shorter absences need two working days of notice. Leave is confirmed only after your manager approves the request.

You may carry over up to 5 unused days into the next leave year. Carried-over days must be used by 31 March, after which they expire. Unused leave is not paid out except when you leave the company.

The company observes 12 public holidays each year. The list is published in December for the following year. If you work on a public holiday at a client's request, you receive one replacement day of leave.

Managers may decline a leave request if too many people in the same team have already booked the same dates, or if a client deadline makes the absence impractical. A declined request should be discussed with you and an alternative date offered.

If you fall ill during annual leave, the days of illness can be recorded as sick leave instead, provided you tell your manager at the time and follow the normal sick leave rules.

Sick leave and family leave

Employees receive 10 days of paid sick leave per leave year. Tell your manager as early as possible on the first day of illness. A medical certificate is required after three consecutive days of sick leave. Unused sick leave does not carry over.

Primary caregivers receive 26 weeks of paid parental leave. Secondary caregivers receive 4 weeks of paid parental leave, which can be taken in up to two blocks within the first year after a birth or adoption.

Bereavement leave of 5 paid days is available on the death of a close family member. Additional unpaid leave can be agreed with your manager and People Operations.

When you return from parental leave or from more than two weeks of sick leave, your manager will arrange a return-to-work meeting to agree a phased schedule if you need one.

Medical appointments that cannot be scheduled outside working hours do not need to be recorded as sick leave. Agree the time with your manager and make up the hours where practical.

Employees with caring responsibilities for an elderly or disabled relative may request a temporary change to their working pattern. People Operations will review each request within two weeks and confirm the outcome in writing.

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Remote and hybrid work

Employees may work remotely for up to 3 days per week. Teams agree shared office days so that collaboration time is predictable. Client site visits count as office days.

To help set up a safe workspace, the company pays a one-time home office stipend of INR 15,000. Claim it within your first three months using the normal expense process. The stipend is not repeated if you change address.

Working from another country is permitted for a maximum of 30 days in any 12-month period. Before working abroad you must complete security review SEC-09 with the Security Office, because tax, data protection and export rules differ between countries.

Remote work uses the same security rules as the office. Work only on a company laptop or an enrolled personal device, lock your screen when you step away, and avoid public Wi-Fi without the company VPN.

Your home workspace should have a suitable chair, enough light and a stable internet connection. Facilities can provide a checklist and advice on setting up a comfortable desk.

Managers may ask for more office days during project kick-offs, client workshops or training weeks. Such requests should be made at least one week in advance so that you can plan travel.

Business travel

All business travel must be approved before booking. Submit form TRV-2 with the purpose, dates and estimated cost. Your manager approves domestic trips; international trips also need approval from the Finance team.

Book travel through the company travel desk at least 14 days before departure where possible. Late bookings are allowed for urgent client work, but the reason must be stated on form TRV-2.

Flights shorter than 6 hours are booked in economy class. Longer flights may be booked in premium economy. Trains are preferred over flights for journeys under four hours.

Hotel stays in metro cities are capped at INR 6,000 per night including taxes. Choose hotels from the preferred list where available. Travel insurance is provided automatically for approved trips.

Keep your manager informed of your travel plans and share an itinerary with the travel desk. If plans change during a trip, update the booking through the travel desk rather than booking directly with an airline or hotel.

Frequent flyer points and hotel loyalty rewards earned on business travel may be kept, but they must never influence the choice of supplier or the cost of a booking.

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Expenses and reimbursement

Submit expense claims with form EXP-4 within 30 days of the date the cost was incurred. Claims submitted later than 30 days need written approval from the Finance team.

During approved travel a daily allowance of INR 900 covers meals and incidentals. You do not need receipts for the daily allowance. For other costs, attach a receipt for every item above INR 300.

Each claim must include the cost centre of the project or team that will pay for it. If you are unsure of the code, ask your manager before submitting the claim.

Approved claims are reimbursed in the next payroll cycle. Alcohol, fines, personal entertainment and upgrades you chose for personal reasons are not reimbursable.

Receipts must show the date, supplier and amount. A card statement alone is not accepted as a receipt. If a receipt is lost, complete the missing receipt declaration in the expense system and explain the circumstances.

Finance checks a sample of claims every month. If a claim breaks this policy, the amount may be rejected or recovered from a later payroll, and repeated breaches are handled under the conduct policy.

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IT equipment and support

Every employee receives a company laptop. Laptops are refreshed every 36 months, or earlier if a device fails and cannot be repaired. Return your old laptop within two weeks of receiving a replacement.

If a laptop, phone or security key is lost or stolen, report it to the IT service desk within 1 hour of noticing. Call extension 4357 or email servicedesk@example.com. The service desk will lock the device and reset your credentials.

Personal phones and tablets may access work email only after they are enrolled in mobile device management. Enrollment lets the service desk wipe work data if the device is lost.

Do not install unapproved software on company laptops. Request new software through the service desk portal so that the license and security checks can be completed.

Keep your laptop updated by restarting it at least once a week so that security patches can be installed. Devices that miss updates for 30 days may be blocked from the network until they are updated.

Accessories such as a monitor, keyboard, mouse and headset can be requested through the service desk portal. Accessories are company property and are returned when you leave.

Information security

Passwords must be at least 14 characters long and must not be reused from personal accounts. Change a password only if you suspect it has been exposed. Never share passwords with anyone, including coworkers and managers.

Multi-factor authentication is required on all work accounts. Administrators must use a hardware security key as their second factor.

Information is classified as Public, Internal, Confidential or Restricted. Confidential information may be shared only with people who need it for their work. Restricted information must never be copied to USB drives or personal cloud storage.

Report suspicious emails with the Report Phish button in the mail client. If you clicked a link or entered credentials, also contact the IT service desk immediately.

Lock printed confidential documents away when you leave your desk and shred them when they are no longer needed. Do not discuss client information in public places where you may be overheard.

Security incidents, such as sending a file to the wrong person, must be reported to the Security Office as soon as you notice them. Early reporting limits the impact and is never treated as a disciplinary matter by itself.

Learning and development

Each employee has an annual learning budget of INR 40,000 for courses, books and certifications. Unused budget does not carry over to the next year.

To attend a conference or external course, submit form LD-3 to your manager at least one month in advance. If the event requires travel, a separate travel request is also needed.

Employees receive 2 paid study days per year to prepare for professional examinations. Study days are booked like annual leave but do not reduce your leave allowance.

If the company pays more than INR 100,000 for a single course and you resign within 12 months of completing it, you must repay a share of the cost in proportion to the months remaining.

Managers discuss learning goals with each employee during performance reviews. Approved learning activities should link to your current role or to a role you are preparing for.

Internal workshops, mentoring sessions and lunch-and-learn talks are free and do not use your learning budget. The schedule of internal sessions is published on the intranet every quarter.

Performance and pay

Performance reviews take place twice a year, in April and October. Each review covers goals, feedback from colleagues and a development plan for the next six months.

Salaries are paid on the last working day of each month by bank transfer. Payslips are available on the payroll portal two days before payment.

Pay is reviewed once a year after the April review. Any change applies from 1 May. Pay bands for each role are published on the intranet.

A discretionary annual bonus may be awarded based on company results and your review ratings. Eligibility requires at least six months of service by 31 March.

If you disagree with a review outcome, raise it with your manager first. If the disagreement remains, you may ask People Operations for a second review by another senior manager within 14 days of receiving the outcome.

Promotions are considered during the October review. A promotion case includes evidence of work at the next level and feedback from at least three colleagues.

Health, safety and wellbeing

If the fire alarm sounds, leave the building by the nearest exit and gather at the assembly point in car park B. Do not use the lifts. Fire wardens will confirm when it is safe to return.

Each office has trained first aiders whose names are posted near the reception desk. First aid kits are kept in every kitchen.

Report any accident, injury or near miss within 24 hours using form HS-1, even if nobody was hurt. Facilities reviews every report to prevent repeat incidents.

The employee assistance programme offers 6 free confidential counselling sessions per year for employees and their immediate family. Sessions can be booked by phone or video.

Hazards such as loose cables, broken chairs or spills should be reported to Facilities so that they can be fixed quickly. Do not attempt electrical repairs yourself.

Employees who need adjustments for a health condition or disability can request them from People Operations. Requests are handled confidentially and adjustments are reviewed once a year.

Conduct and leaving the company

Treat colleagues, clients and suppliers with respect. Harassment and discrimination are never acceptable and can be reported to People Operations or anonymously through the ethics line.

Gifts or hospitality worth more than INR 2,000 must be declared in the gifts register within one week of receiving them. Cash gifts must always be refused.

The notice period is 60 days for both the employee and the company, unless your contract states otherwise. Remaining annual leave may be used during the notice period with manager approval.

Return your laptop, security key and access card on your last working day. People Operations will invite you to an optional exit interview in your final week.

Conflicts of interest, such as a family member working for a supplier, must be declared to your manager and People Operations. Declaring a conflict early allows it to be managed fairly.

Confidentiality obligations continue after you leave. Do not take client data, source code or internal documents with you, and delete any work files stored on personal devices.